

INTELLIGENCE BRIEF / N° 003 · HOT

Cohesity

AI Data Security / Data Protection · San Jose, CA · Private (Nvidia-backed; 2026 IPO, ~\$8-17B target)

Nvidia-backed Cohesity hit ~\$1.5B ARR after absorbing Veritas and is steering toward a 2026 IPO at a valuation rivalling Rubrik's \$17B - with no motorsport presence and an open data-security slot on the grid.

83

OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW
HOTSERIES
F1RECOMMENDED TEAM
WilliamsACTION HORIZON
6-10 WKS

THE CASE

Cohesity is the rare combination our mandate prizes: a category leader at a brand-reckoning moment. Following its 2024 merger with Veritas' data-protection business, ARR surged to ~\$1.5B at a 28% adjusted margin, and the Nvidia-backed company is eyeing a 2026 IPO with a valuation aimed at its public peer Rubrik (~\$17B). It has never touched motorsport, so we would not be the 100th brand in the inbox - and the data-security/resilience category is unoccupied on the F1 grid.

WHY NOW

An IPO is the single biggest brand-elevation moment a company gets. A multi-year F1 partnership signed around the listing converts a finance event into a global enterprise-brand statement and pre-builds the institutional credibility public investors reward.

SPINOFF UNICORN

NEVER ENTERED

FUNDING EVENT

CATEGORY WHITESPACE

DISCOVERY: SELF

WHY WILLIAMS

Williams - the data-and-engineering revival story (Atlassian title, Confluent on data streaming) - is the natural canvas for a data-resilience brand, placing Cohesity beside complementary (not competing) data partners in front of enterprise IT buyers.

VALUE TO WILLIAMS — MODE A (TECH IN THE CAR / CHAMPIONSHIP)

MODE A. A Williams race weekend produces and must safeguard enormous volumes of telemetry, simulation output and design IP - exactly Cohesity's domain (backup, recovery, ransomware resilience). That supports an authentic technical-partner integration and 'we protect the data that wins races' storytelling, not a sticker.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Official Data Resilience Partner tier on Williams. MINIMUM THREE YEARS (ideally four to span the IPO and post-listing cycle), estimated \$4-7M/yr. Garage/cockpit branding in the data-security category, hospitality at marquee rounds, digital rights for an enterprise-IT audience, category exclusivity.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Cohesity CMO / CEO Sanjay Poonen (verify current CMO)

MARKETING LEADERSHIP / CEO (IPO SPONSOR)

CEO Sanjay Poonen (ex-VMware) drives Cohesity's enterprise-brand and IPO narrative; confirm the current CMO and IR lead, who co-own brand-investment decisions during the listing window.

OPENING ANGLE

"You get one IPO. An F1 data-resilience partnership turns your listing into a global enterprise-brand moment - and data security is the one category no rival on the grid can claim. Worth 25 minutes before the roadshow locks?"

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING

18 / 20

Targeting a 2026 IPO - the brand-reckoning moment for a category leader; Veritas merger (Dec 2024) pushed ARR to ~\$1.5B.

CAPACITY

18 / 20

ARR ~\$1.5B, 28% adjusted margin, Nvidia-backed, IPO valuation rivalling Rubrik's ~\$17B. Easily funds title-adjacent spend.

BRAND FIT

17 / 20

Data security/resilience maps to F1's data-obsessed, zero-failure culture; no data-protection brand on the grid.

URGENCY

15 / 20

IPO window is a one-time elevation moment; Rubrik (public peer) raises category competitiveness.

OPS FIT

15 / 20

MODE A: an F1 team generates and must protect petabytes of telemetry and IP - a genuine data-resilience use case in the garage.

RISKS & COUNTERS

IPO QUIET PERIOD Securities rules may restrict marketing announcements near the listing. **Counter:** Sign quietly, activate post-listing; use the roadshow to build internal consensus.

INTEGRATION FOCUS Post-Veritas integration may absorb leadership attention. **Counter:** Position the deal as the external proof point that the merged company is now one category leader.

SOURCES

- <https://www.cnbc.com/2025/09/04/nvidia-backed-cohesity-eyes-2026-ipo-with-valuation-rivaling-17-billion-rubrik.html>
- <https://strategyofsecurity.com/p/cybersecuritys-ipo-pipeline-2026-and-beyond>